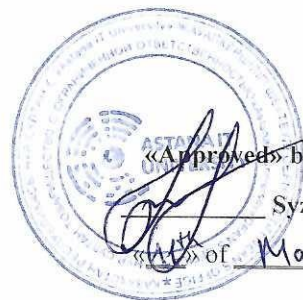




«Approved» by the Dean

Syzdykova Z.

«Date» of March 2024

Syllabus

Academic Year 2023-2024

1. General Information	
Course title	Academic Writing, Department of General Education Disciplines
Degree cycle (level)/major	Bachelor's degree, all majors
Year, term	2023-2024; 6, 7 & 8 trimesters
Number of credits	5
Language of delivery	English
Prerequisites	Foreign Language 1 and Foreign Language 2,
Postrequisites	Research methods and tools, Diploma writing

Lecturer(s)	M. Abzhaparova m.abzhaparova@astanait.edu.kz , A. Aldaberdykyzy a.aldaberdykyzy@astanait.edu.kz M. Amanzhol m.amanzhol@astanait.edu.kz A. Ayazbayeva, aliya.ayazbayeva@astanait.edu.kz A. Bakenova ainur.bakenova@astanait.edu.kz R. Batyrkhanova r.batyrkhanova@astanait.edu.kz S. Burbekova saule.burbekova@astanait.edu.kz , K. Hassenov k.hassenov@astanait.edu.kz , A. Ichshanova aelita.ichshanova@astanait.edu.kz , N. Ishmukhambetov nariman.ishmukhambetov@astanait.edu.kz , E. Gerfanova, elmira.gerfanova@astanait.edu.kz T. Karimova togzhan.almas@astanait.edu.kz , R. Kenzhebekova r.kenzhebekova@astanait.edu.kz Kh. Kenzhetayev kh.kenzhetayev@astanait.edu.kz A. Olzhabayeva a.olzhabayeva@astanait.edu.kz A. Ormanova a.ormanova@astanait.edu.kz , T. Rakisheva t.rakisheva@astanait.edu.kz , A. Seidin ariya.seidin@astanait.edu.kz , A. Seksenbayeva a.seksenbayeva@astanait.edu.kz M. Smagulova moldir.smagulova@astanait.edu.kz , Zh. Tusselbayeva zhanar.tusselbayeva@astanait.edu.kz , A. Urazbekova aigerim.urazbekova@astanait.edu.kz , Y. Verba y.verba@astanait.edu.kz , M. Zhenisbayeva meruyert.zhenisbayeva@astanait.edu.kz , G. Zhumagaliyeva guldana.zhumagaliyeva@astanait.edu.kz , D. Zhanabilova d.zhanabilova@astanait.edu.kz , S. Zhalmagambetova saltanat.zhalmagambetova@astanait.edu.kz ,
Manager of General Education Department	Saniya Karimova saniya.karimova@astanait.edu.kz , AITU, office C1.1.269
2. Goals, Objectives and Learning Outcomes of the Course	
Course Description	The Academic Writing course aims to enhance students' proficiency in academic English through a comprehensive approach that includes reading authentic publications in their field, composing their own mini-research papers, and presenting them during the final examination. The syllabus has been developed to align with the Education program of the BA degree (refer to Degree cycle (level)/major). By the conclusion of the course, students will possess the ability to effectively apply their knowledge and skills in academic English, exhibit competence in the language, and fulfill the coursework assignments set by Astana IT University. Additionally, students will have the opportunity to present their mini-research projects at Student Conferences, incorporating enhancements based on their mentors' feedback.
Course Goal(s)	This course aims at putting core academic language skills into practice in the framework of writing a mini research paper.

Course Objectives:	• familiarizing students with the structure and expectations of academic conferences, enabling them to identify suitable conferences, align their research with conference themes, and meet specific submission requirements, • fostering students' analytical skills by teaching them how to identify a problem and formulate research questions based on the evaluation and synthesis of the relevant academic publications, • equipping students with academic vocabulary to present research techniques, including collecting, analyzing, and presenting data, and citing sources accurately, • enabling students to academically communicate their mini research paper, handle questions, and engage in the course discussions.
Skills & Competences	• summarise, analyse and evaluate academic texts using social annotation platform and reference managing platform, etc. while identifying and highlighting their main ideas and messages, • learn and apply academic vocabulary through lectures, seminars and independent activities, • develop students' own voice and create a balance between their voice and incorporation of research sources via paraphrasing, summarizing and quoting, • enhance students' academic English use and collaborative skills through constructive peer feedback.

Course Learning Outcomes:	By the end of this course students will be able to: Knowledge • Select at least 5 peer-reviewed journal articles that are relevant to the mini research paper • Describe the context of the mini research based on sources • Define the main concepts of the mini research paper • Develop an understanding of the structure of academic research papers and submission requirements at student conferences Comprehension • Compare, and contrast different perspectives, concepts, or findings and develop insightful connections or patterns among sources. • Formulate the research context by identifying overarching themes or trends in literature Application • Apply the conventions of APA referencing style 7th edition and be aware of how to avoid plagiarism • Discover scientific databases to locate appropriate academic sources, evaluate those sources and integrate them thoughtfully, responsibly, and ethically in their own writing • Develop abilities to recognize and use Academic Vocabulary, Phrase Bank and Patterns Analysis • Connect the ideas from academic sources to build the background of the mini research paper • Determine the research problem in the chosen field • Explain the research significance • Formulate the research question(s) • Examine the collected data Synthesis • Strengthen the ability to write texts using academic language using the process approach • Summarize information from academic sources, distinguishing between main ideas and details • Integrate different academic sources using the sandwich approach • Articulate the synthesized information effectively through writing assignments or a poster presentation, ensuring clarity, cohesion, and coherence Evaluation • Assess peers' papers following the assessment criteria rubrics • Evaluate the relevant concepts and methods • Convince the reader of the significance of the research
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Methods of Assessment	During this course students will develop four linguistic skills: writing, reading, listening and speaking. Writing and reading skills will be assessed through step-by-step preparation of the mini research paper. Listening and speaking will be assessed through in class and final poster presentations. Students need to cover all the assignments by the due date and time (See Student Performance Evaluation System for the Course in Table 4). The final grade for the course in percentage is determined by the formula: $F\% = \frac{R1 + R2}{2} \times 0,6 + E \times 0,4,$ R1 - the percentage of the 1st rating, R2 - the percentage of the 2nd rating, E - the percentage of the examination mark Control types of student's progress: Current control – combined Midterm control (R1) - combined; Endterm control (R 2) – combined If according to MT-1 a student gets less than 25 points (25%) and was also absent from the defense of the media presentation (research project) without a good reason, then he/she does not receive admission to the final exam
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Reading List	Assigned reading materials and presentations should be read prior to class. Class lectures and discussions will proceed with supplemental and advanced topics, which could be difficult to understand unless students have read the assigned material. Readings are listed in the schedule section. All necessary updates and/or changes to the course will be reflected in the Learning Management System (moodle.astanait.edu.kz/). <u>Core Literature:</u> • Paterson, K., & Wedge, R. (2018). Oxford Grammar for EAP: English grammar and practice for Academic Purposes. Oxford University Press. • Swales, J. M., & Feak, C. B. (2012). Academic writing for graduate students: Essential tasks and skills (Vol. 1). Ann Arbor, MI: University of Michigan Press. • McCormack, J., & Slaght, J. (2012). Extended writing & research skills. Garnet Education. • Graff, G., Birkenstein, C., & Maxwell, C. (2014). They say, I say: The moves that matter in academic writing (p. 245). Gildan Audio. <u>Supplementary literature:</u> • Kumar, R. (2018). Research methodology: A step-by-step guide for beginners. Sage. • Pickard, A. J. (2013). Research methods in information. Facet publishing • Taylor & Francis Journals Standard Reference Style Guide: American Psychological Association, Seventh Edition (APA-7). • Bottomley, J. (2021). Academic writing for international students of science. Routledge. • Readings: the academic publications in the field of study Supplementary resources are referenced in the weekly class presentations will be made available to students.
Course policy	Attendance: Since students are expected to write in nearly every class, attendance is critical and failure to attend at least 70% of the classes will result in a failing grade. Student attendance for the class hours shall be recorded. Being late up to 10 minutes three times will be counted as one missed lesson. In cases, when a student misses a class due to valid reasons in addition to the relevant documentation (medical reports/references must be provided to the professor no later than 2 weeks after the absence), the student will have to review the missed lecture materials and complete the practice class assignments to cover the absence. The details of the review of the missed classes should be agreed upon with the instructor and all the requirements must be fulfilled. The student absence is not excused based only on the document from the dean's office. Preparation for Class: Class participation is a very important part of the learning process in this course. Students will be evaluated during practical classes and lectures when

completing tasks presented according to the syllabus. Students are required to cite and work with the sources written only in English.

Class work: The duration of each lecture and practical lesson is 50 minutes, and student independent work. Students are expected to complete all assignments ahead of time, attend class regularly and participate in lecture and practical class discussions. In case of a student's systematic misconduct, the student can be expelled from the classes. Class hours will take place according to the timetable, and home assignments will be posted on Moodle/Microsoft Teams. The course will require both group and autonomous work by students, with most course time devoted to studying the accompanying materials and applying knowledge and skills in the Academic Writing course. The class hours serve as a setting for interacting with groupmates and practicing knowledge and skills the students acquire from the course materials.

Midterm/End term: Students who score less than 25% for Midterm/End term automatically fail the course.

Homework/Assignments: The course instructions and assignments will be posted on Moodle. This means students should access materials, do the work and post their completed assignments by the due time. These tasks are mandatory and will determine the course grade. The course includes:

- Presentation of research article analysis
- Writing and submission of research problem and research question(s)
- Midterm: Test 1 on language focus and academic article evaluation
- Concepts submission
- Research Data Presentation
- Endterm: Test 2 on language focus and academic article evaluation.

Final Exam: A summative assessment of students' knowledge and skills acquired during this course in the form of a poster presentation along with the written final draft of their mini-research paper.

Late submissions: Most assignments will be discussed in class on the due date. All gradings are based using a percentage grading scale.

NOTE:

1. You will lose 5% of the mark for each day of being late (relates both to homework and in-class assignments).
2. Work submitted later than three days after the deadline will not be accepted (Relates both to homework and in-class assignments).

Academic Conduct Policies of the university: The main principles of academic integrity are responsibility for studies, honesty, trust, fairness, and respect. Plagiarism is a violation of academic integrity, i.e., using someone else's words or ideas without acknowledgment of sources. You can find out more about avoiding plagiarism at <http://plagiarism.org>. The rules of academic integrity of Astana IT University are in the Course documents folder on Moodle. Astana IT University «Academic Integrity Policy of Astana IT University». All the written assignments submitted by students on Moodle are checked for originality in the StrikePlagiarism service.

3. Course Content

#	Abbreviation	Meaning
1	ISIS	Instructor-supervised independent work
2	SIS	Students' independent work
3	IP	Individual project
4	PA	Practical assignment
5	BA degree	Academic degree Bachelor of Arts

3.1 Lecture and Practical Plans

Week No	Course Topic	Lectures (H/W)	Practice sessions (H/W)	ISIS (II/W)	SIS (II/W)
1	Lecture 1: Course Introduction and Overview Lecture 2: Introduction to the Conference Submission Guideline Seminar 1: Research Paper Brainstorming and Topic Selection in Groups Seminar 2: Developing SMART Goals and Individual Plans Seminar 3: Language Focus: Academic Language and Tone (Part 1)	2	3	1	9
2	Lecture 1: Introduction to Article Evaluation. Part 1 Lecture 2: Introduction to Article Evaluation. Part 2 Seminars 1-2: Practice Analyzing and Presenting a Research Article Seminar 3: Language Focus: Evaluating the Published Article	2	3	1	9
3	Lecture 1: Introduction to Research Context, Problem and Research Question Lecture 2: Defining Research Aim and Objectives Seminar 1: Practice: Formulating Research Problem Seminar 2: Developing Research Context Seminar 3: Language focus: Quotation, Paraphrasing and Summarizing	2	3	1	9

4	Lecture 1: Incorporating Sources to Support Ideas Lecture 2: Citation Styles: APA and IEEE Seminars 1-2: Peer review: Drafting Research Problem and Research Questions Using Sources Seminar 3: Language focus: Language of Summaries	2	3	1	9
5	Lecture 1: Theories and Concepts Lecture 2: Extended Definitions of Terms Seminars 1-2: Midterm: Test 1 on language focus and academic article evaluation Seminar 3: Language focus: Extended definitions	2	3	1	9
6	Lecture 1: Introduction to Research Methods and Data Collection Tools Lecture 2: Basics of Research Ethics Seminars 1-2: Practice: Designing a Questionnaire and Collecting data Seminar 3: Language focus: Language of Data Commentary	2	3	1	9
7	Lecture 1: Incorporating Data and Illustrations: Questionnaire Lecture 2: Incorporating Data: Interview Seminar 1: Practice: Conducting a Focus Group Interview Seminar 2: Practice: Interpreting Questionnaire and Interview Data Seminar 3: Language focus: Linking Phrases in Methods Section	2	3	1	9
8	Lecture 1: Explaining Research Significance Lecture 2: The Difference between Significance, Rationale and Justification Seminar 1-2: Research Data Presentation Seminar 3: Language Focus: Academic Language and Tone (part 2)	2	3	1	9
9	Lecture 1: Writing Conference Abstract Lecture 2: Preparing Poster Presentation for Conference Seminar 1: Abstract writing practice Seminar 2: Drafting the final poster Seminar 3: Language focus: Preparing for conference presentation	2	3	1	9

10	Lecture 1: Reviewing Exam Policy Lecture 2: Course Revision Seminars 1-2: Endterm: Test 2 on language focus and academic article evaluation Seminar 3: Course Reflection: Survey	2	3	1	9
	Total hours:	20	30	10	90
		50		100	

3.2 List of Assignments for Instructor-supervised Student Independent Study

No	Assignments (topics) for Independent study	Hours	Recommended literature and other sources (links)		Form of submission
1	Developing SMART Goals and Individual Plans	1	Weekly study materials		MS Word
2	Discuss and choose one published article to analyse and present your review in class	1	Weekly study materials		Presentation
3	Before seminar 2: 1. Find at least 3 articles relevant to your research background info/context.	1	Weekly study materials Swales, J. M., & Peak, C. B. (2012). Academic writing for graduate students: Essential tasks and skills (Vol. 1). Ann Arbor, MI: University of Michigan Press.		MS Word

4	1. Submission 10%: Write 400–500 words explaining your research context, research problem, aim and research question(s) and submit in MS word doc to Moodle following the criteria rubric. 2. Peer review: work in groups and give written feedback based on the rubric to another group and submit it onto Moodle	1	Weekly study materials Swales, J. M., & Feak, C. B. (2012). Academic writing for graduate students: Essential tasks and skills (Vol. 1). Ann Arbor, MI: University of Michigan Press, (p. 225-226). Academic Phrasebank The University of Manchester		MS Word according to APA 7 th ed requirements
5	Review language focus tasks, weekly materials to take the midterm test	1	Weekly study materials		Recommendation: Preparing Quizlet
6	1. Submission: 5% Identify one key concept in relation to the topic of the research paper in 100-150 words and submit in MS word doc to Moodle following the criteria rubric. 2. Peer review: work in groups and give written feedback based on the rubric to another group and submit it onto Moodle 3. Before seminar 1: Learn how to create a questionnaire using Microsoft Forms 4. After seminar 2: Take your peers' questionnaire, provide peer feedback based on the criteria:	1	Weekly study materials Swales, J. M., & Feak, C. B. (2012). Academic writing for graduate students: Essential tasks and skills (Vol. 1). Ann Arbor, MI: University of Michigan Press. How to use Microsoft Forms: Watch https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ouFKWHQVNiQ Read https://www.howtoexcel.com/400488/how-to-create-a-questionnaire-in-microsoft-forms		MS Word according to APA 7th ed requirements Microsoft Forms

7	Conduct a survey using your questionnaire. Send the link of your questionnaire to at least 10 other students. Respond to each other's surveys by Week 7, Seminar 1. Upload the summary link of your questionnaire onto Moodle by week 7, Seminar 1.	1	Weekly study materials <u>Academic Phrasebank The University of Manchester</u>		Microsoft Forms
8	Presentation 15%: Prepare your research data presentation	1	Weekly study materials		PPT (or any other presentation tool) APA 7 th edition
9	Polishing the poster for the final	1	Weekly study materials		PPT (or any other presentation tool) APA 7 th edition
10	Review language focus tasks, weekly materials to take the end term test	1	Weekly study materials		-

3.3 List of Assignments for Student Independent Study

No	Assignments (topics) for Independent study	Hours	Recommended literature and other sources (links)	Form of submission
1	- Choosing a research topic - Compound sentences	9	Videos on Moodle From Coursera courses: Introduction to Research for Essay Writing Grammar and Punctuation	Note-taking of the videos
2	Finding and Evaluating Academic Sources More on Finding Sources and Note-taking	9	Videos on Moodle From Coursera courses: Introduction to Research for Essay Writing Grammar and Punctuation	Note-taking of the video
3	- Academic Tone and Language Video Lecture - Adverb Clauses	9	Videos on Moodle From Coursera courses: Introduction to Research for Essay Writing Grammar and Punctuation	Note-taking of the video

4	- Using EasyBib Video Lecture - More uses of comma	9	Videos on Moodle From Coursera courses: Introduction to Research for Essay Writing Grammar and Punctuation	Note-taking of the video
5	Review language focus tasks, weekly materials to take the midterm test	9	Course materials of weeks 1-4	Recommendation: Preparing Quizlet
6	- Using Statistics in Writing Video Lecture - The use of THEREFORE	9	Videos on Moodle From Coursera courses: Introduction to Research for Essay Writing Grammar and Punctuation	Note-taking of the video
7	Statistics Optional Reading	9	Videos on Moodle From Coursera courses: Introduction to Research for Essay Writing Grammar and Punctuation	Note-taking of the reading material
8	- The Academic Word List and Reporting Verbs Video Lecture - Parallel Structure	9	Videos on Moodle From Coursera courses: Introduction to Research for Essay Writing Grammar and Punctuation	Note-taking of the video
9	Sentence Variety	9	Videos on Moodle From Coursera courses: Introduction to Research for Essay Writing Grammar and Punctuation	Note-taking of the video
10	Review language focus tasks, weekly materials to take the end term test	9	Course materials of weeks 5-10	Preparing for the end-term test

4. Student Performance Evaluation System for the Course

Period	Assignments	Weight (%)	Deadline
Midterm Assessment	Presentation of research article analysis (PR)	10	Week 2
	Writing and submission of research context, aim, and research question(s) (RC)	10	Week 4
	Midterm: Test 1 on language focus and academic article evaluation (MT)	10	Week 5

End term Assessment	Concepts submission (CS)	5	Week 6
	Research Data Presentation (DP)	15	Week 8
	End term: Test 2 on language focus and academic article evaluation (ET)	10	Week 10
Final exam*	Poster Presentation + Final Draft (FINAL)	40	TBA
Total	$(0,33*PR+0,33*RC+0,34*MT)+(0,16*CS+0,5*DP+0,34*ET)+0,4*FINAL$	100	

Achievement level as per course curriculum shall be assessed according to the evaluation chart adopted by the academic credit system.

Letter Grade	Numerical equivalent	Percentage	Grade according to the traditional system
A	4,0	95-100	Excellent
A-	3,67	90-94	
B+	3,33	85-89	
B	3,0	80-84	Good
B-	2,67	75-79	
C+	2,33	70-74	
C	2,0	65-69	Satisfactory
C-	1,67	60-64	
D+	1,33	55-59	
D	1,0	50-54	Fail
FX	0	25-49	
F	0	0-24	

General Weekly Speaking and Writing Rubric

Letter Grade	Percentage	Speaking Criteria	Writing Criteria
A	95-100	Can produce clear, smoothly flowing well-structured speech with an effective logical structure which helps the recipient to notice and remember significant points.	Can write clear, smoothly flowing, complex texts in an appropriate and effective style and a logical structure which helps the reader to find significant points.

A-	90-94	Can give clear, systematically developed descriptions and presentations, with appropriate highlighting of significant points, and relevant supporting detail	Can write clear, well-structured texts of complex subjects, underlining the relevant salient issues, expanding and supporting points of view at some length with subsidiary points, reasons and relevant examples, and rounding off with an appropriate conclusion.
B+	85-89		
B	80-84	Can give clear, detailed descriptions and presentations on a wide range of subjects related to his/her field of interest, expanding and supporting ideas with subsidiary points and relevant examples.	Can write clear, detailed texts on a variety of subjects related to his field of interest, synthesising and evaluating information and arguments from a number of sources.
B-	75-79	Can reasonably fluently sustain a straightforward description of one of a variety of subjects within his/her field of interest, presenting it as a linear sequence of points.	Can write straightforward connected texts on a range of familiar subjects within his field of interest, by linking a series of shorter discrete elements into a linear sequence
C+	70-74		
C	65-69	Can give a simple description or presentation of people, living or working conditions, daily routines, likes/dislikes etc. as a short series of simple phrases and sentences linked into a list	Can write a series of simple phrases and sentences linked with simple connectors like "and", "but" and "because".
C-	60-64		
D+	55-59		
D	50-54	Can produce simple mainly isolated phrases about people and places.	Can write simple isolated phrases and sentences
FX	30-49		
F	0-29		

Adapted from:

<https://mcoe.int/COLRMPublic/CommonSearchServices/DisplayDC/Content?documentId=0000001000141456>

Based on the specific grade for each assignment, and the final grade, following criteria must be satisfied:

Grade	Criteria to be satisfied
90-100	- Work would be worthy of further dissemination under appropriate conditions - Mastery of advanced methods and techniques at a level beyond that explicitly taught - Ability to synthesize and employ in an original way idea from across the subject - Outstanding command of critical analysis and judgment

80-89	- Excellent range and depth of attainment of intended outcomes - Mastery of a wide range of methods and techniques - Evidence of study and originality of what has been taught - Able to display a command of critical analysis and judgement
70-79	- Attained all the intended learning outcomes for a unit - Able to use well a range of methods and techniques to come to conclusions - Able to employ critical analysis and judgement
60-69	- Some limitations in attainment of learning objectives, but has managed to grasp most of them - Able to use most of the methods and techniques taught - Evidence of study and comprehension of what has been taught but grasp insecure - Some grasp of the issues and concepts underlying the techniques and material taught, but weak and incomplete
50-59	- Attainment of only a minority of the learning outcomes - Able to demonstrate a clear but limited use of some of the basic methods and techniques taught - Weak and incomplete grasp of what has been taught - Deficient understanding of the issues and concepts underlying the techniques and material taught
25-49	- Attainment of nearly all the intended learning outcomes deficient - Lack of ability to use at all or the right methods and techniques taught - Inadequately and incoherently presented - Wholly deficient grasp of what has been taught - Lack of understanding of the issues and concepts underlying the techniques and material taught
0-24	No significant assessable material, absent or assessment missing a must pass component

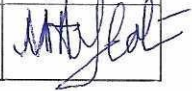
5. Methodological Guidelines

Assessment is administered continuously throughout the course. The students are rated against their performance in continuous rating administered throughout the semester (60%) and summative rating done during the examination session (40%), total 100%. Continuous rating is students' on-going performance in class and independent work. Class work is assessed for attendance, presentation defense and in-class assessments.

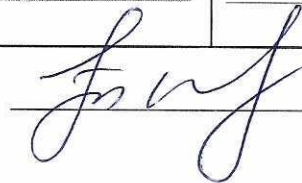
- **ISIS (Instructor Supervised Student Independent Study)** consists of weekly assignments to be done by students independently and checked by instructor.
- **Mid-term and End-term** is an assessment of each student's knowledge and skills in the form of a paper-based task.
- **Final assessment** is a summative assessment of students' knowledge and skills acquired during this course in the form of a poster presentation in groups.

6. Lecturer (lecturers) approvals

Full name	Job title	Contacts	Date	Signature
Zhanar Tusselbayeva	Associate professor	zhanar.tusselbayeva@zastanaii.edu.kz	_____/2024	

Aigerim Urazbekova	Senior lecturer	aigerim.urazbekova@astanait.edu.kz	____.____.____//2024	
Ariya Seidin	Senior lecturer	Ariya.seidin@astanait.edu.kz	____.____.____//2024	
Moldir Amanzhol	Lecturer	m.amanzhol@astanait.edu.kz	____.____.____//2024	

Director of General Education Disciplines
Department



Zh. Tlesnova